FIELD STUDY | CONSUMER JOURNEY MAPPING

# Reading a Business No One Has Written About

Foundation Institute: a neighbourhood tuition centre, Sector 10A, Gurugram
How a student finds, joins, experiences and recommends the centre

## ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report maps the consumer journey of one small, local business. It uses direct observation, an owner interview and two student interviews to ask: **why do students choose, stay with and recommend this centre, and what small changes would strengthen the experience?**

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|---|---|
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| **Business studied** | Foundation Institute, Sector 10A, Gurugram (tuition for Classes III–XII) |
| **Evidence base** | Field observation, 1 owner interview, 2 student interviews, photographs |
| **Nature of findings** | Qualitative. Useful for understanding the journey and forming hypotheses, not statistically representative. |

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# 1 Executive summary

Foundation Institute is a tuition centre that has run for about 13–14 years in Sector 10A, Gurugram. It teaches all subjects for Classes III–XII with 8 teachers and roughly 80–90 students. This study follows the student's journey from first hearing about the centre to deciding whether to stay and whether to recommend it.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **13–14+ yrs** in operation | **8 teachers** for ~80–90 students | **~12** average batch size | **4–8 PM** class timings |

## Key findings

| | |
|---|---|
| 1 | **The value is not "tuition". It is experienced teaching, individual attention and doubt solving.** Students link the centre to academic improvement, and that is also their main reason to continue. |
| 2 | **The experience stage is already strong.** Participation is high, the classroom is clean and organised, and both interviewed students would recommend the centre. |
| 3 | **The weak points are at the edges of the journey.** Getting students in (awareness to enrolment) is informal, and small irritants appear: Sunday classes, an occasional AC problem, fast-paced teaching for some, board updates and limited space. |
| 4 | **The main business constraints are people and space.** The owner names finding skilled teachers, expanding space and local outreach as the hardest problems. |

KEY INSIGHT

The centre is already strong where it matters most. The opportunity is to make the path **into** the centre more systematic and to remove small service irritants that can weaken an otherwise positive experience. Three headline actions: **(1)** fix the high-frequency irritants first, **(2)** make academic improvement visible and formalise referrals, **(3)** protect individual attention as numbers grow.

## 2 Business profile

| Field | Fieldwork finding |
|---|---|
| **Business** | Foundation Institute |
| **Location** | Sector 10A, Gurugram |
| **Years of operation** | Approximately 13–14+ years |
| **Subjects / classes** | All subjects, Classes III–XII |
| **Teachers** | 8 |
| **Students** | Approximately 80–90 |
| **Class timings** | 4:00 PM–8:00 PM |
| **Average batch size** | Approximately 12 students |
| **Main discovery channels** | Local hoardings and posters; referrals |
| **Communication** | WhatsApp for timetable and cancellations; PTM and calls for parents |
| **Improvement budget reported** | Approximately ₹2–3 lakh |
| **Implementation window reported** | Approximately 1 week |

Reading the numbers. With 80–90 students and ~12 per batch, the centre runs roughly 7 batches (derived, not reported). That keeps classes small, which fits the “individual attention” students value and is the thing growth could erode.

## 3 Fieldwork methodology

| Method | What it covered |
|---|---|
| **Direct observation** | The centre, the classroom environment and student behaviour. |
| **Owner interview** | Motivation, student profile, acquisition, complaints, operational challenges and improvement constraints. |
| **Two student interviews** | Discovery, alternatives considered, reasons for joining, likes and dislikes, continuation and recommendation. |
| **Photographs** | Classroom layout, learning environment and student participation. |

**NOTE ON THE EVIDENCE**

The findings are qualitative and based on a small sample (1 owner, 2 students). They show how the journey works and point to hypotheses worth testing. They should not be read as representative of every student.

## 4 Primary customer persona

**"The Academic Improver"** is a Class 10 student who joins tuition mainly to improve academic performance, especially in subjects where extra support is needed.

| Persona element | What the fieldwork suggests |
|---|---|
| **Goal** | Improve marks, understand difficult topics and do better in school exams. |
| **Motivations** | Individual attention, experienced teachers, doubt solving and visible academic improvement. |
| **Discovery** | Local advertising and hoardings; word of mouth and relatives. |
| **Evaluation** | Teaching quality, teacher experience, organisation and alternatives nearby. |
| **Pain points** | Fast-paced study for some learners; Sunday classes; occasional AC issues; communication and update gaps. |
| **Decision trigger** | Belief that the centre can give more personal academic support than school alone. |
| **Loyalty trigger** | Improvement in academics and confidence in the teachers. |

## 5 Customer journey map

The journey has seven stages. The strip shows how each stage looks from the fieldwork; the table gives the detail.

| 1 Awareness | 2 Consideration | 3 Enrolment | 4 Learning | 5 Support and comms | 6 Retention | 7 Advocacy |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| STRONG | STRONG | OPPORTUNITY | STRONG | MIXED | STRONG | OPPORTUNITY |
| Hoardings, posters, referrals; easy to find | Teaching quality and individual attention stand out | No simple, repeatable enquiry flow yet | High participation and doubt solving | WhatsApp works; update gaps remain | Academic improvement keeps students | Both students would recommend; no referral system |

**Navy** = working well · **Steel** = mixed · **Gold** = biggest opportunity. Colours are an interpretation of the fieldwork, not a score the students gave.

### Journey detail

| Stage | Customer action | What works | Customer thought | Opportunity |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1 Awareness** | Sees local hoardings and posters; hears about the centre from relatives. | Easy to find; strong local visibility. | "I know this place exists." | Make local awareness measurable. |
| **2 Consideration** | Compares teaching, organisation, teacher experience and nearby alternatives. | Teaching quality and individual attention stand out. | "Will this help me improve?" | Show outcomes, subject support and teacher strengths. |
| **3 Enrolment** | Student or parent chooses a subject or course and joins. | Personal interaction and academic need drive the decision. | "This seems right for my need." | Use a simple enquiry → trial → enrolment flow. |
| **4 Learning** | Attends classes, asks questions, completes work. | High participation, clean classroom, doubt solving. | "I am actually learning." | Protect the high-touch teaching experience. |
| **5 Support and comms** | Gets timetable and cancellation updates; parents use PTM and calls. | WhatsApp is convenient; parent contact is available. | "The centre keeps me informed." | Create one consistent communication format. |
| **6 Retention** | Decides to continue based on progress and comfort. | Academic improvement and experienced teachers. | "I should stay because it is helping." | Track progress and celebrate improvement. |
| **7 Advocacy** | Recommends the centre to friends and relatives if satisfied. | Both interviewed students would recommend it. | "I can suggest this to others." | Build a referral loop. |

## 6 Experience analysis: what works and what creates friction

| Area | Field evidence | What it means |
|---|---|---|
| **Strongest moments** | Teaching quality; individual attention; experienced teachers; doubt-solving sessions; high participation; clean, organised environment. | These are the reasons most likely to create satisfaction and retention. |
| **Functional convenience** | Local visibility; 4–8 PM timings; WhatsApp timetable and cancellation updates; parent PTM and calls. | These reduce effort for students and parents. |
| **Friction points** | Sunday classes; occasional AC problems; fast-paced teaching for some; board update issue; space limits. | Small irritants matter more when students compare alternatives. |
| **Business constraint** | Finding skilled teachers; expanding space; local outreach is the biggest growth challenge. | Growth must widen reach without damaging the high-touch classroom. |

## 7 Key pain points and root causes

Evidence strength differs. The AC issue and the board update were each mentioned specifically, and Sunday classes were reported as a complaint. For Sunday classes the reason behind the complaint was not explored, so that root cause is still open.

| Pain point | Root cause | Action | Effort* |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Fast-paced studies** | Pace may suit stronger students but leave slower learners behind. | Add a 10-minute recap and doubt checkpoint at the end of each class. | Low |
| **Sunday classes** | Reported by students as a complaint. The reason was not explored. | Review frequency; announce schedules earlier; use Sundays for tests and revision where possible. | Low |
| **AC / classroom comfort** | An AC issue was specifically mentioned; space is also a constraint. | Fix basic maintenance and seating before any expensive expansion. | Low–Med |
| **Board / update issue** | One student named board updating as a dislike. | Use a simple visible routine: syllabus progress, next test, homework, notices. | Low |
| **Outreach** | Owner names nearby student outreach as the biggest challenge. | Strengthen referral marketing and hyperlocal visibility beyond posters. | Medium |

*Effort is an estimate, not a costed figure.

## 8 Opportunity areas

**01** **Make the journey visible**
Create a simple enquiry path: enquiry → subject need → trial → parent discussion → enrolment.

**02** **Turn academic improvement into proof**
Use anonymised before-and-after test progress, subject-wise improvement stories and parent feedback with consent.

**03** **Build a referral engine**
Students already arrive through relatives and references. Formalise this with a simple referral message or benefit.

**04** **Protect individual attention**
Monitor batch size and teacher capacity as enrolment grows, so the main differentiator is not lost.

**05** **Fix high-frequency irritants first**
Handle AC maintenance, Sunday scheduling and update visibility before any major spending.

# 9 Recommended one-week action plan

The owner reported about one week to implement and a budget of roughly ₹2–3 lakh. Most steps below are process changes, so they fit the one-week window. No cost estimate was made.

| Day | Action | Owner |
|---|---|---|
| **Day 1** | List all current student and parent touchpoints and common complaints. | Owner + teachers |
| **Day 2** | Create a standard WhatsApp format for timetable, cancellations and weekly updates. | Admin |
| **Day 3** | Create a one-page student progress tracker with test score and topic status. | Teachers |
| **Day 4** | Launch a small referral message for existing students and parents. | Owner |
| **Day 5** | Inspect AC, seating and classroom comfort; fix urgent issues. | Owner / maintenance |
| **Day 6** | Pilot a 10-minute recap and doubt checkpoint in one batch. | Teacher |
| **Day 7** | Review feedback and decide what to scale. | Owner + teachers |

### How to know it worked (record a baseline first, compare after a term)

| Measure | Why it matters |
|---|---|
| **Enquiries per week, by source (hoarding, referral, other)** | Makes local awareness measurable (Stage 1). |
| **Enquiry → trial → enrolment conversion** | Shows whether the enrolment path works (Stage 3). |
| **Referrals received** | Tests the referral loop (Stage 7). |
| **Students continuing from term to term** | Direct retention measure (Stage 6). |
| **Test-score change per student** | Evidence of the main outcome students care about. |
| **Complaints by theme (pace, Sunday, AC, updates)** | Shows whether the irritants are shrinking. |

# 10 Conclusion and limits

Foundation Institute has a strong local-service foundation. Students can find it easily, the learning environment is organised, participation is high and individual attention is visible. The outcome students care about most is academic improvement, and it is also their strongest reason to continue.

The strategic opportunity is therefore not to reinvent the service. It is to make the existing value easier to discover, easier to evaluate and more consistently delivered. A disciplined referral system, clearer communication, visible progress tracking and small classroom fixes can strengthen the whole journey without losing the personal teaching students value.

### Limits of this study

- **Small sample:** one owner and two students.
- **Current students only:** students who left, and parents, were not interviewed. People who stay are usually the satisfied ones, so friction may be understated. Next step: interview a few former students and parents.

# Appendix

## A. Interview guide used

| Owner interview | Student interviews |
|---|---|
| • Why was the tuition centre started?<br>• Who is the typical student?<br>• Why do students join the centre?<br>• Why do students continue?<br>• How do new students hear about the centre?<br>• What do students like most?<br>• What complaints are commonly received?<br>• What is the biggest business challenge?<br>• What budget and time are available for improvements?<br>• What improvement is difficult to make right now? | • How did you discover the centre?<br>• What alternatives did you consider?<br>• What made you join?<br>• What would make you leave?<br>• Would you recommend the centre, and why? |

## B. Field visit




*Field visit at Foundation Institute.*